

General relativity HW-9

PROBLEM 1. Consider FLRW (or Friedmann) Universe with matter. Consider cases of zero spatial curvatures. Consider separately two kinds of matter: dust and radiation. For each of this matter components derive a time dependence of a scale-factor.

SOLUTION:

By Friedmann equation

$$\left(\frac{\dot{a}}{a}\right)^2 = \frac{8\pi G}{3}\rho - \frac{k}{a^2}$$

Because we are considering zero spatial curvature, then $k = 0$.

For dust, $\rho = ma^{-3}$, then

$$a^{\frac{1}{2}}da = \frac{8\pi Gm}{3}dt \implies a^{\frac{3}{2}} - a_0^{\frac{3}{2}} = 4\pi Gmt \implies a \propto t^{\frac{2}{3}}$$

For radiation, $\rho = ma^{-4}$, then

$$ada = \frac{8\pi Gm}{3}dt \implies a^2 - a_0^2 = \frac{16\pi Gm}{3}t \implies a \propto t^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

PROBLEM 2. The same, but take the spatial curvature to be ± 1 and derive answers for a radiation only.

SOLUTION:

For $k = 1$,

$$\left(\frac{\dot{a}}{a}\right)^2 = \frac{8\pi Gm}{3a^4} - \frac{1}{a^2} \implies \dot{a}^2 = \frac{\beta^2}{a^2} - 1 \implies \int \frac{ada}{\sqrt{\beta^2 - a^2}} = \int dt$$

Where $\beta = \sqrt{\frac{8\pi Gm}{3}}$. Let $a = \beta \sin \gamma$, then if $a_0 = 0$,

$$\int \frac{ada}{\sqrt{\beta^2 - a^2}} = \int \frac{\beta^2 \sin \gamma \cos \gamma d\gamma}{\beta \cos \gamma} = \sqrt{\beta^2 - a_0^2} - \sqrt{\beta^2 - a_1^2} \implies a^2 = 2\beta t - t^2$$

Clearly $t \in [0, 2\beta]$ and $a \in [0, \beta]$.

For $k = -1$,

$$\left(\frac{\dot{a}}{a}\right)^2 = \frac{8\pi Gm}{3a^4} + \frac{1}{a^2} \implies \dot{a}^2 = \frac{\beta^2}{a^2} + 1 \implies \int \frac{ada}{\sqrt{\beta^2 + a^2}} = \int dt$$

Let $a = \beta \tan \gamma$, then if $a_0 = 0$,

$$\int \frac{ada}{\sqrt{\beta^2 + a^2}} = \int \frac{\beta \sin \gamma d\gamma}{\cos^2 \gamma} = \frac{\beta}{\cos \gamma} = \sqrt{\beta^2 + a_1^2} - \sqrt{\beta^2 + a_0^2} \implies a^2 = t^2 + 2\beta t$$

For large $t, a \sim t$. This agrees with the figure in Carroll's book, where $k = +1$ is a closed curve, and $k = -1$ increase faster than $k = 0$.